

phones in the country. The marketing and sales strategy that the brand followed in India has been quite similar to that followed by its closest rival Mi.

The market share of Realme during the first quarter of 2021 (in terms of shipment volume) was close to just 5.1% (IDC Report). Its direct competitors, Samsung and Mi, held close to 19% and 27.2% market share during the same quarter, respectively.

“BBK has one of the best strategies when it comes to targeting different segments of consumers. There is at least one brand positioned in every segment, and the best part is that all these brands follow different marketing strategies,” says an analyst not wishing to be named.

Oppo and Vivo, BBK’s other smartphone brands, which were probably initially launched to target the ₹15,000 to ₹25,000 smartphones segment in the country, held 4.7% and 6.6% market share during the same quarter, respectively. The smartphones launched by these two brands have been locking horns with other mid-range smartphones in India from the very beginning.

The combined sales figures of Vivo, Oppo, and Realme for the quarter stood at around 15.4% of the total market share. Comparing these with the market share of the Xiaomi and Samsung answers how well the strategy of having multiple brands catering to different target audiences has worked out for BBK. It is worth mentioning here that the sales figures of OnePlus and Iqoo are not included in these numbers.

BBK’s OnePlus has been projected as a flagship smartphone brand, from the beginning. Tech gurus have been comparing OnePlus smartphones with the flagship models offered by Samsung and Apple in India and in other countries as well. Several reports by Counterpoint Research and IDC have declared OnePlus as the clear winner. Iqoo is the newest brand on the block from the house of BBK.

“You can breach both the online and offline channels using the same products by white labeling into different brands. The same helps penetrate online via a different strategy than the offline despite the products being quite similar to each other,” says the analyst.

Evolution beyond the target audience

The other advantage of having a multiple brands strategy is in getting the room to play and extend your target audience. For instance, Oppo and Vivo both have forayed into the flagship smartphone market and have started offering smartphones that cost above ₹50,000. The step, from the house of BBK, came right after the organisation was able to create dedicated fan following and communities for these two brands. There is a high chance that consumers using phones from these brands would upgrade to their flagship models due to customer loyalty.

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Oneplus, which has till now been known as the flagship smartphone brand from the house of BBK, started offering its first below ₹30,000 smartphone in 2019-20. The move might have helped BBK to attract consumers who were looking for a flagship name without having to spend flagship amounts. It is rumored that OnePlus will also be launching a below ₹20,000 smartphone this year.

“Once you have successfully created a brand image, it becomes easier to launch new product categories under the same brand name. This is generally done keeping the loyalty of consumers in mind. Moreover, if you can give them a good product, it also becomes essential for the brand to give them more such good products,” says the analyst.

Xiaomi, one of the competitors to possibly all the smartphone brands in the world, has also done something similar with its sub brand POCO. The latter, which was originally introduced as a flagship brand years ago, has now started launching smartphones for the budget-friendly market. Several users

have even posted comments noting that POCO smartphones are white labelled smartphones from Xiaomi.

And if playing and extending the circle of target audience was not enough, these smartphone brands have now started to evolve into complete consumer electronics brands. Oppo and Vivo have now started to offer smart bands and other wearables in the market while OnePlus and Realme now have smart TVs under their product portfolios. Similarly, Xiaomi is one of the market leaders in the smart TV market in India, and the company keeps on adding one or more product categories every now and then.

“If you associate a brand with

a flagship image, you are bound to respect the brand when it launches a product in the affordable or less expensive segment. A lot of brands have followed this strategy earlier,” says the analyst.

Coming to the giant of the consumer electronics industry, Samsung’s is a story that needs more than one OTT series to explain what all it does. While most of us know Samsung as a big consumer electronics giant, only a few of us are aware of the fact that a lot of its competitors use display panels and other key components used in their TVs, smartphones, smartwatches, and other products that are sourced from Samsung. The Korea based tech giant however does not supply these key components under one brand name but different brands that operate under the umbrella of the parent brand called Samsung Electronics.

Some not so popular yet critical for the electronics industry brands owned by Samsung include Prismview that targets the manufacturing of light-emitting diode displays, Novaled that specialises in the research and devel-